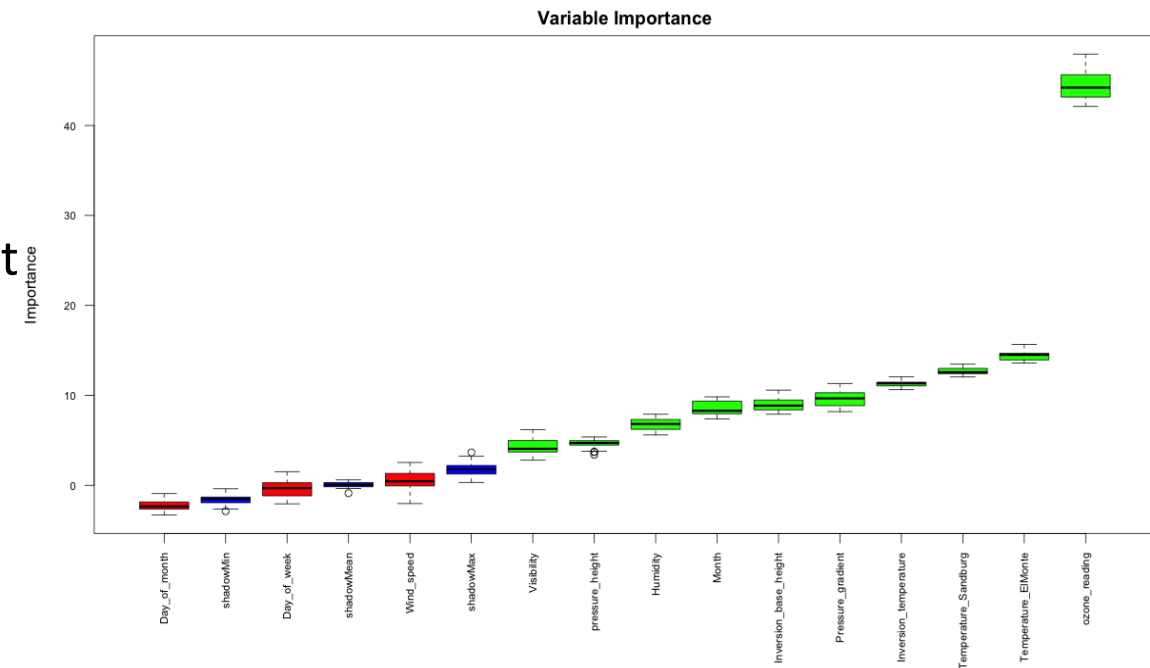


Attribute Subset Selection

- ❑ Another way to reduce dimensionality of data
- ❑ Redundant attributes
 - ❑ Duplicate much or all of the information contained in one or more other attributes
 - ❑ E.g., purchase price of a product and the amount of sales tax paid
- ❑ Irrelevant attributes
 - ❑ Contain no information that is useful for the data mining task at hand
 - ❑ Ex. A student's ID is often irrelevant to the task of predicting his/her GPA



Heuristic Search in Attribute Selection

- ❑ There are 2^d possible attribute combinations of d attributes
- ❑ Typical heuristic attribute selection methods:
 - ❑ Best single attribute under the attribute independence assumption: choose by significance tests
 - ❑ Best step-wise feature selection:
 - ❑ The best single-attribute is picked first
 - ❑ Then next best attribute condition to the first, ...
 - ❑ Step-wise attribute elimination:
 - ❑ Repeatedly eliminate the worst attribute
 - ❑ Best combined attribute selection and elimination
 - ❑ Optimal branch and bound:
 - ❑ Use attribute elimination and backtracking

Attribute Creation (Feature Generation)

- ❑ Create new attributes (features) that can capture the important information in a data set more effectively than the original ones
- ❑ Three general methodologies
 - ❑ Attribute extraction
 - ❑ Domain-specific
 - ❑ Mapping data to new space (see data reduction)
 - ❑ E.g., Fourier transformation, wavelet transformation, manifold approaches (not covered)
 - ❑ Attribute construction
 - ❑ Combining features (see discriminative frequent patterns in Chapter on “Advanced Classification”)
 - ❑ Data discretization